

AI Governance is Broken

Gartner says:

Uniform Governance Will Get
Your Agents Decommissioned

*and most enterprises are
locking every agent down the
same way.*



Aruna Pattam



The Governance Trap

Locked down or fully trusted.
Nothing in between.

"Lock it down"

Over-restriction slows delivery and drives shadow AI

"Trust it fully"

Under-restriction raises security, compliance and operational risk

"Same controls for every agent"

Treats a chatbot and an autonomous claims agent identically

"Enterprises are treating AI agent governance as binary - that is the root cause of failure."
- Shiva Varma, Gartner

4 Levels of Agent Autonomy

Gartner's Proportional Governance Model

L1: Observe

1

Read-only access. Lightweight controls: scoped data, logging, basic testing.

L2: Advise

2

Drafts and recommendations only. Humans execute; watch for automation bias.

L3: Act with Approval

3

Act with Approval: Executes after explicit human approval. Needs audit trails, or approval fatigue sets in.

L4: Act Autonomously

4

Executes within guardrails. Needs circuit breakers, rollback and named ownership.

What Governance Actually Requires

Controls scale with autonomy,
not optics.

01

Low-Autonomy Agents (L1–L2)

Scoped data access, authentication, usage logging, hallucination and quality testing.

LIGHTWEIGHT, TARGETED

02

Approval-Gated Agents (L3)

Clear approval workflows, audit trails, agent-specific incident response.

EVERY ACTION REVIEWED

03

Autonomous Agents (L4)

Continuous monitoring, enforced guardrails, rollback mechanisms, circuit breakers.

SPEED OUTPACES OVERSIGHT

STOP TREATING GOVERNANCE AS BINARY.

→ Classify every agent by autonomy level before it launches

→ Match controls to risk, not optics:
fully locked or fully trusted is a false choice

→ Build rollback and circuit breakers for L4 agents before an incident forces you to

By 2027, 40% of enterprises will demote or decommission their AI agents.

The failure won't be the agent. It'll be the governance model around it.

For More Details...

Gartner®

Gartner Says Applying Uniform Governance Across AI Agents Will Lead to

Gartner_inc Says Applying Uniform Governance Across AI Agents Will Lead to Enterprise AI Agent Failure. Read more here. #GartnerIT #AIagent #Governance

 Gartner

Learn More @



by
Aruna Pattam



<https://www.arunapattam.com>



<https://www.youtube.com/c/ArunaPattam>



<https://medium.com/arunapattam>



@PattamAruna



aruna.pattam